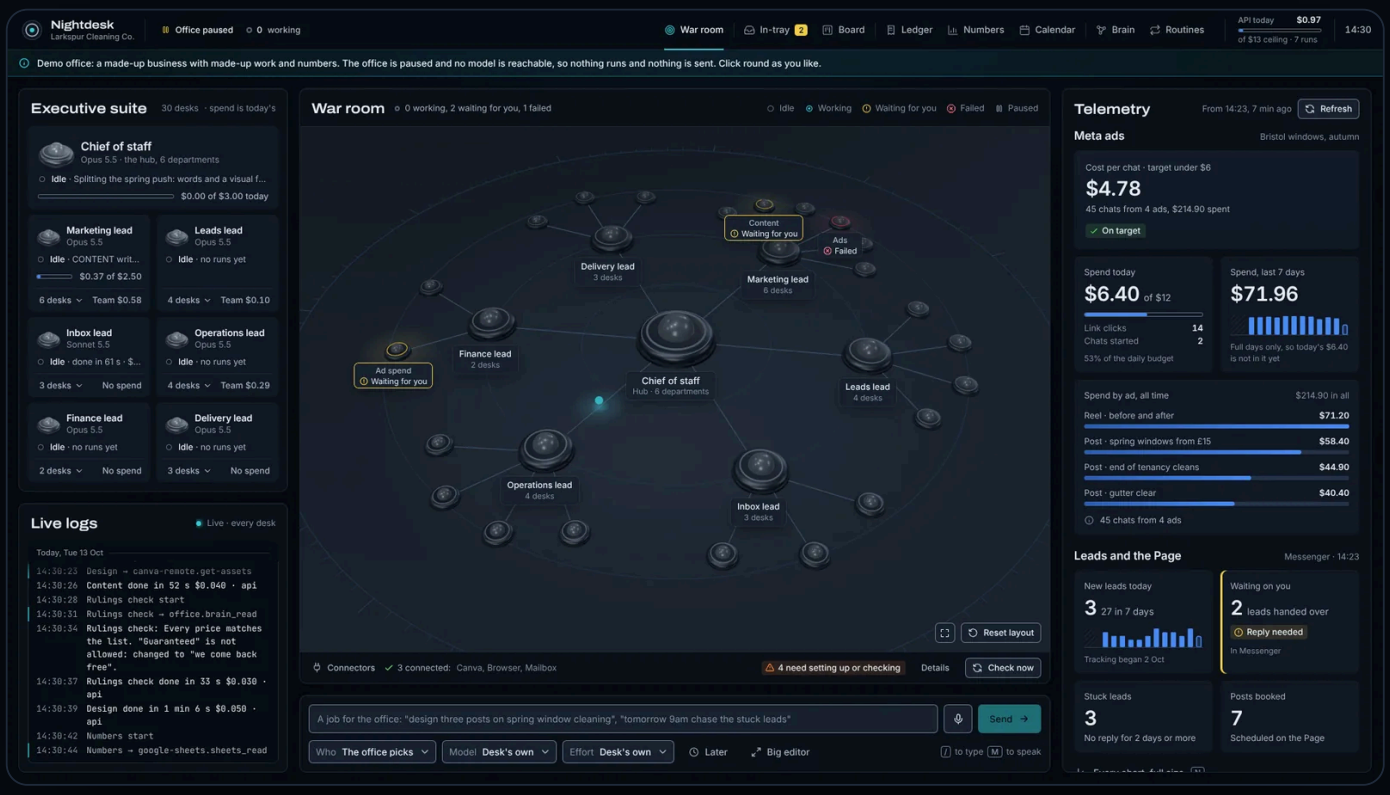
HOW TO USE YOUR OFFICE

Nightdesk, in ten minutes

Your office runs on your own computer at **127.0.0.1:4600**. Desks do the work; you give jobs, read results and say yes or no to anything that goes out. The pictures are the demo office, a made-up window cleaner: run `npm run demo:show` to click round it yourself.

The main screen

Tap a number to see what that part does. Everything else opens from here and closes with `Esc`.



1 Open or paused

Whether the office is taking work, and how many desks are working now. Click it to pause the office: nothing new starts, work in hand finishes. Click again to open.

2 The views

War room is home. In-tray (the number is drafts waiting for you), Board, Ledger, Numbers, Calendar, Brain and Routines each slide in from the right.

3 **Your meter**

API today: money spent on your API key today, against the daily ceiling, and how many runs. Past the ceiling, new jobs wait until midnight.

4 **Executive suite**

The chief of staff and the six department leads: model, what each did last, today's spend. Click a card to open the desk; the arrow under it shows the team.

5 **Live logs**

Everything the office does, line by line, newest at the bottom. With a desk open it shows that desk only. Scroll up to hold still; Jump to latest brings you back.

6 **The war room**

A live map of the desks: the chief of staff in the middle, a lead for each department, their desks round them. Click a pod to open it. The ring colour shows its state (see "What the colours mean").

7 **Connectors**

The outside tools the desks use: Drive, Canva, Meta and the rest. Orange means one is failing. Details lists them all; Check now tests them (a minute or two).

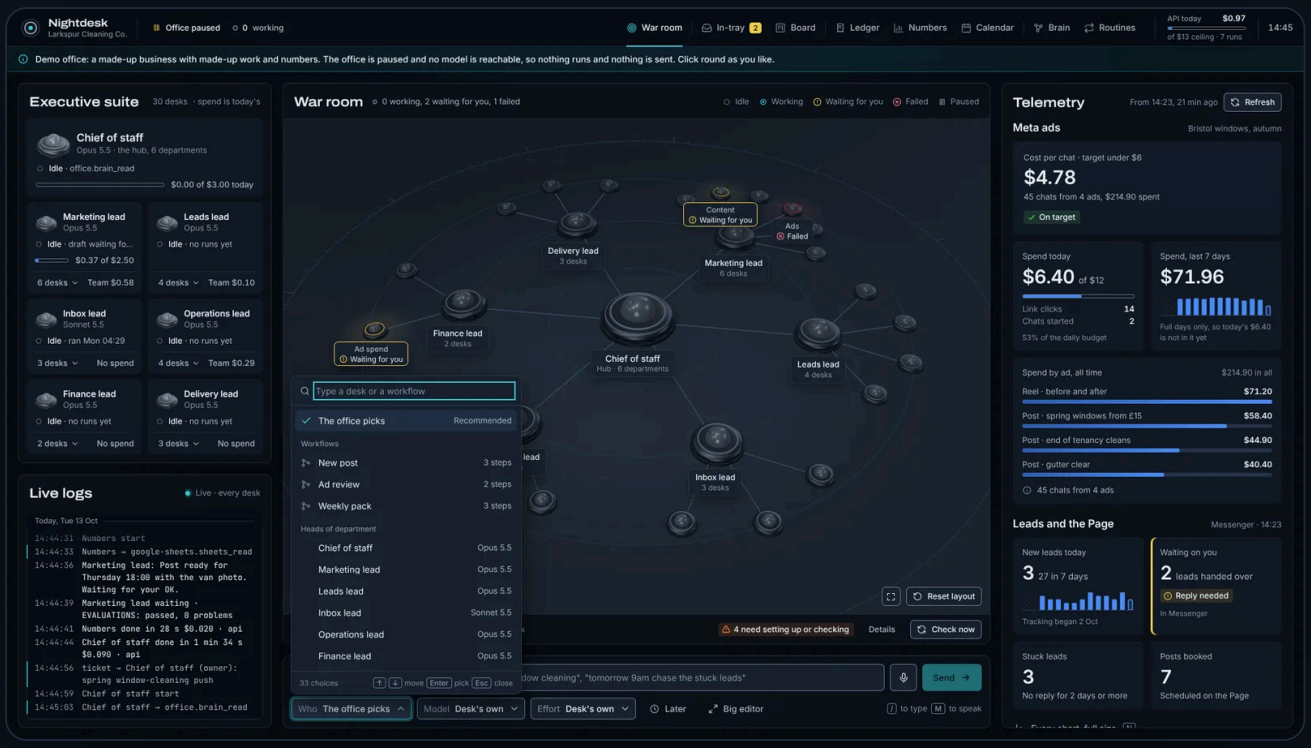
8 **The job bar**

Type a job in plain words and press Send. Who, Model, Effort, Later and Big editor are under it. See "Give the office a job".

9 **Telemetry**

Your ads and leads at a glance: spend today and over 7 days, spend by ad, new leads, who is waiting on you, stuck leads and posts booked. Refresh pulls fresh numbers.

Give the office a job

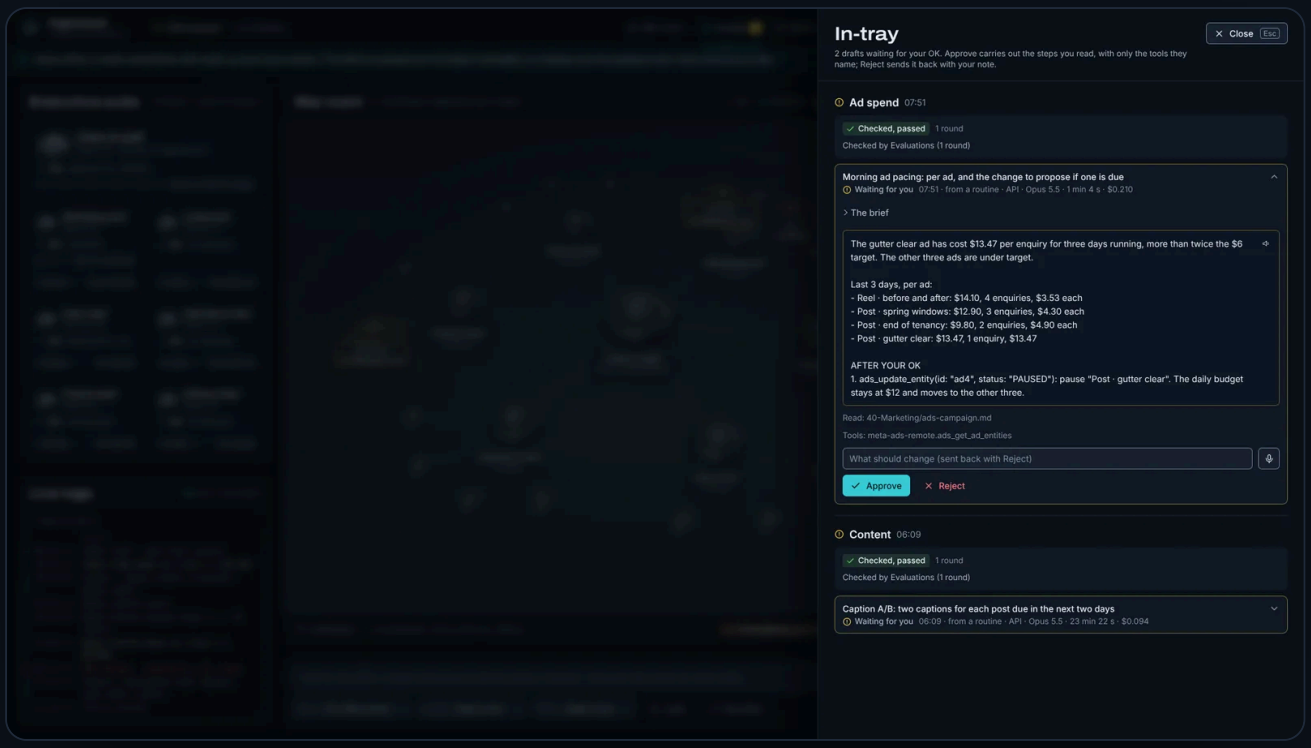


1. Click the job bar at the bottom of the war room, or press `/`. Press `M` to speak it instead.
2. Write it as you would to a person: *design three posts on spring window cleaning*, or *tomorrow 9am chase the stuck quotes*.
3. Press **Send**. The office picks the right desk. To choose one yourself, use **Who**, or start the job with the desk's name: *DESIGN: a post on gutter clearing*.

ⓘ **Later** books it for a date and time. **Big editor** (`Ctrl+Shift+E`) gives a large box for a long brief. Leave **Model** and **Effort** on *Desk's own* unless you have a reason.

You can follow it on the Board and in the desk's "In hand". The result lands in the desk's "Done" and on your phone.

Approve or send back a draft



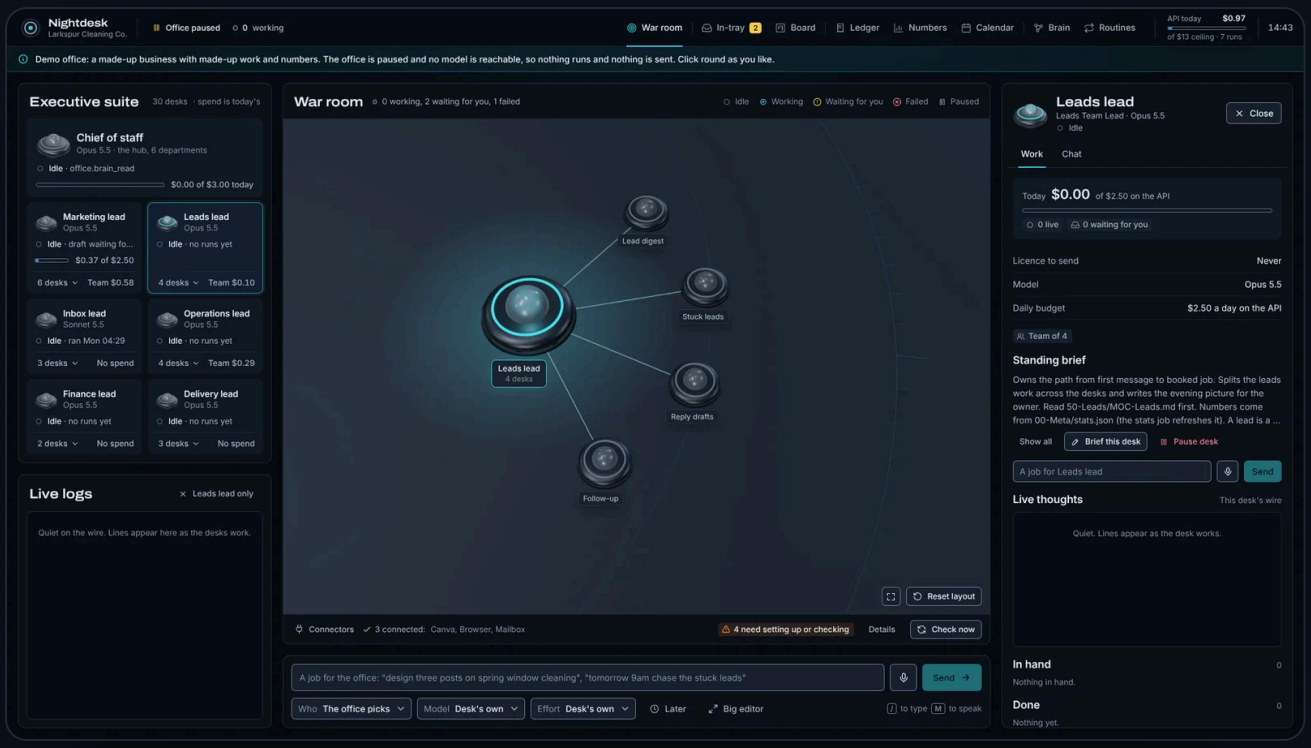
Nothing is sent, posted, booked or spent without your OK. When a desk wants to do one of those, its pod turns yellow and the draft waits in the **In-tray**.

1. Open the In-tray: the **In-tray** tab (its number is how many are waiting), the yellow pod, or `I`.
2. Read the box at the top first. The evaluations desk has already checked the draft: **Passed**, or what problem is left.
3. **Approve** carries out the steps you read, with only the tools they name and the addresses and links in the draft. To change it, type what should change in the box and press **Reject**; it goes back to the desk with your note.

> ⓘ If the office refuses (for example the draft changed while you read it), a red line under the buttons says so and nothing is sent.

On your phone, the same draft arrives in Telegram with APPROVE and REJECT buttons.

Look after a desk



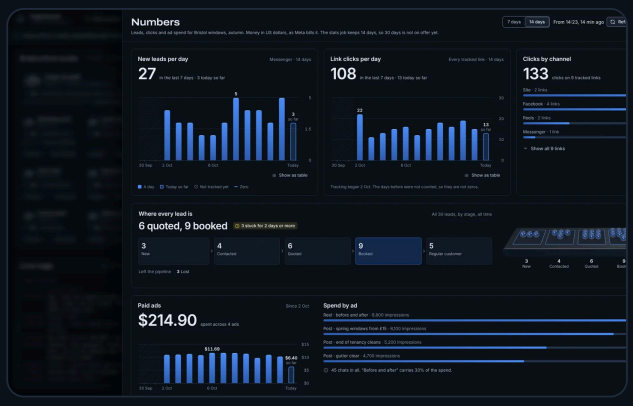
Click a desk's card in the executive suite or its pod in the war room (or press `1` to `6` for the department leads). The war room zooms to its team and its page opens on the right.

1. **Work**: today's spend against its budget, whether it may send things (with your OK), its model, the tools it uses, and its standing brief.
2. **Brief this desk** changes its standing brief. **Pause desk** stops it taking new work. The box gives a job to this desk only.
3. Below: its live thoughts, what it has **In hand**, and what it has **Done**. Open any ticket to read the result, reply, or retry.
4. **Chat** lets you talk to the desk directly.

Close it, or press `0` or `Esc`, to go back to the whole office.

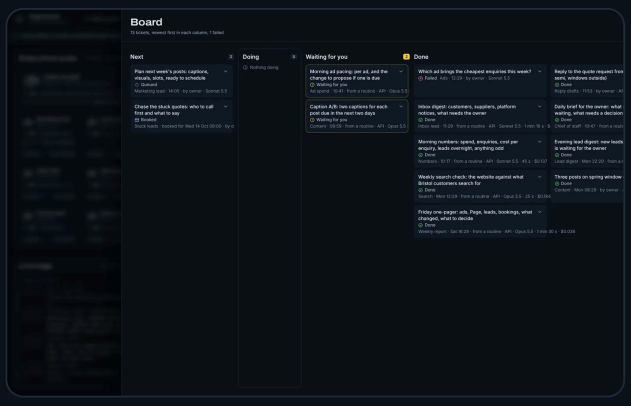
The views

The tabs along the top. Each one slides in from the right; `Esc` closes it.



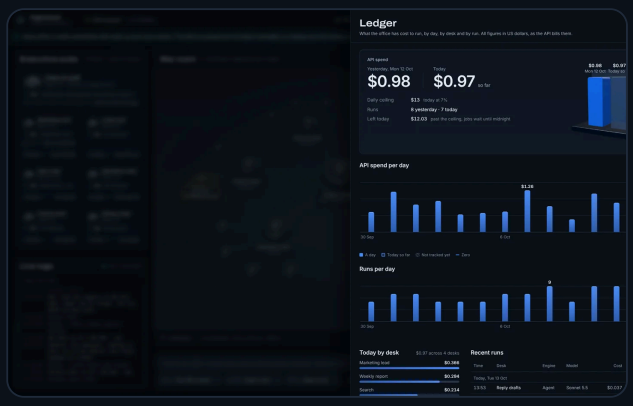
Numbers `N`

Leads and link clicks per day, clicks by channel, where every lead stands, and the paid ads. Switch 7 or 14 days. Every chart has **Show as table**. Hatched days were not tracked yet; they are not zeros.



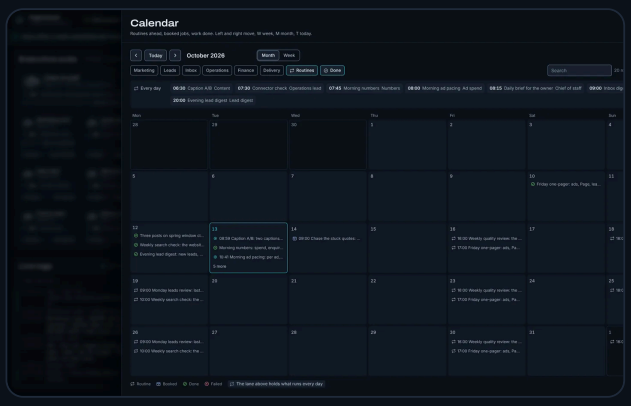
Board `B`

Every job in columns: Next, Doing, Waiting for you, Done. Open one to read it, reply to it, retry it or cancel it.



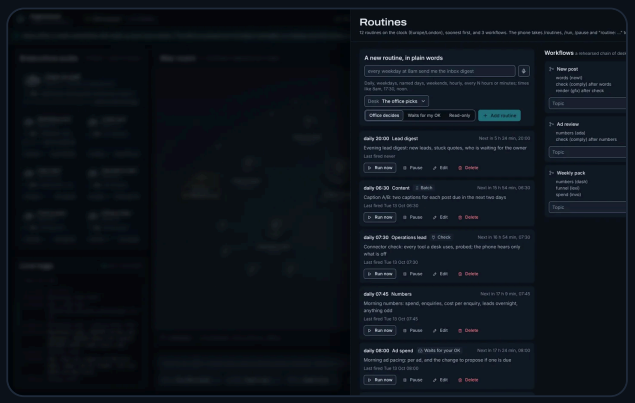
Ledger `L`

What the office has cost on your API key: yesterday, today, by desk, by model and by engine, and every run. Past the daily ceiling ($13 unless you change it), new jobs wait until midnight.



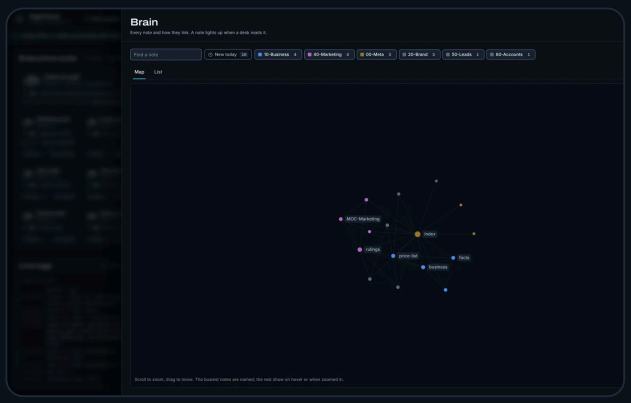
Calendar `C`

Routines ahead, jobs booked for later, and work done, by day. The lane at the top is what runs every day. Press **+** on a day to book a job for it.



Routines R

The office's clock. Add one in plain words (*every weekday at 8am send me the inbox digest*), run one now, pause, edit or delete it. Workflows on the right are chains of desks you can start with a topic.



Brain G

Your notes, the office's memory (a folder of markdown files), as a map or a list. A note lights up when a desk reads it. Tap one to read it and see what it links to.

What the colours mean

The ring round each pod, and the word under it, say what the desk is doing.

Idle
Nothing to do.

Working
Busy, or open in your hand.

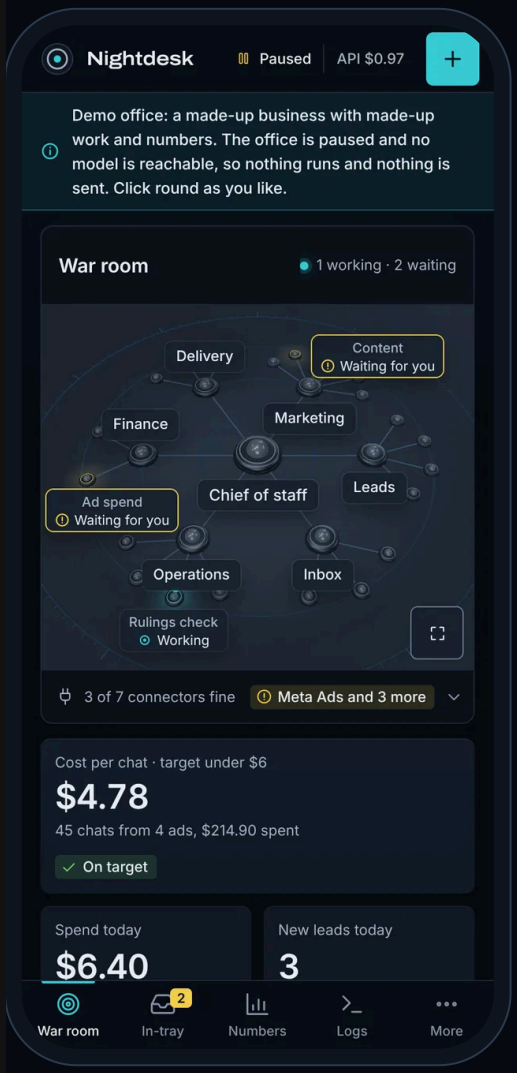
Waiting for you
A draft needs your OK.

Failed
Its last job failed. Open it to retry.

Paused
Takes no new work.

ⓘ Across the page, green means fine, yellow needs you, orange is a problem, and red failed. Teal only ever means "live" or "you can press this".

On a small screen and on your phone



On any screen under 1280 pixels wide the page becomes one page at a time, with tabs at the bottom: **War room**, **In-tray**, **Numbers**, **Logs** and **More** (everything else). The **+** button gives a job. Pausing the office there takes a second tap, so a thumb cannot do it by accident.

Your phone is Telegram

The office talks to you through your Telegram bot. Type a job in plain words and it becomes a ticket. Drafts arrive with **APPROVE** and **REJECT** buttons, and results land there too.

`/waiting`	What is waiting for your OK
`/tasks`	Open jobs and their state
`/routines`	The clock: every routine and when it runs next
`/run morning numbers`	Run a routine now
`/pause`	Pause the office; `/resume` opens it again
`/help`	The full list

Keys

They work whenever you are not typing in a box. `?` shows this list in the office.

`/`	Type a job	`M`	Speak a job
`Ctrl+Shift+E`	The big editor	`1` to `6`	Open a department lead
`0` or `Esc`	Back to the whole office	`I`	In-tray
`B`	Board	`L`	Ledger
`N`	Numbers	`C`	Calendar
`G`	Brain	`R`	Routines
`K`	Check the connectors	`?`	Keys and help

Moving round the war room

Drag a pod	Move it (remembered in this browser)	Drag the table	Turn round the hub
Right-drag	Slide the view	Scroll	Zoom in and out
Click a pod	Open that desk	Reset layout	Put every pod back

Nightdesk by Alex Cojoaca. Free software under the GNU AGPL 3.0. Source code.